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Complete List of ADB Commands and Fastboot Commands

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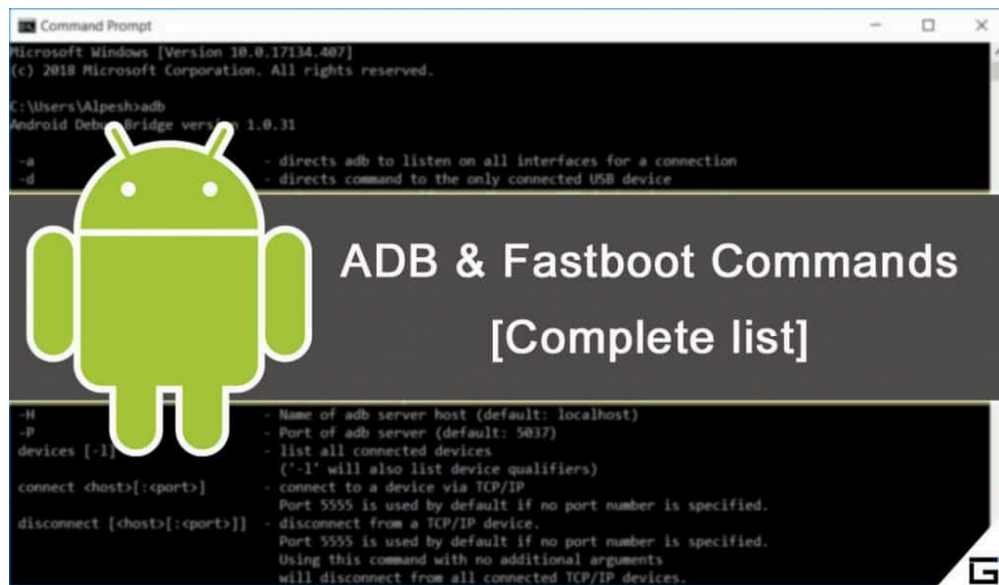
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Android Debug Bridge (adb) is a command-line tool that lets you run commands on the connected Android device or an emulator. It is widely used for development purposes and is already available in Android Studio in *android sdk/platform-tools*. The commands which are run on the device through ADB are called "**adb commands**". Here we are going to have a look at the *complete list of adb and fastboot commands* and what actions they perform.





How Android Debug Bridge (adb) works?

According to Wikipedia (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Android_software_development#ADB), the `adbd` daemon runs on the device and the `adb` client starts a background server to multiplex commands sent to the connected device.

Below is the list of **adb commands** and **fastboot commands** along with the description of what operations it performs.

Also Read

How to Fix “adb not recognized” Error (<https://www.gizmoadvices.com/fix-adb-not-recognized-error/>)

List of ADB Commands and their Functions

adb devices

This command prints a list of all attached devices with [USB Debugging](https://www.gizmoadvices.com/what-is-usb-debugging-how-to-enable-in-android-phones/) enabled. In response, it returns the *serial number* and state of the device.

Syntax:

```
adb devices
```

Response:

```
a123a456    device
```

adb forward

This command forwards the socket connections. It required [USB Debugging](https://www.gizmoadvices.com/what-is-usb-debugging-how-to-enable-in-android-phones/) enabled on the device.

Syntax:



```
adb forward <local> <remote>
```

Example:

```
adb forward tcp:6100 tcp:7100
```

Set up forwarding of the host port `6100` to emulator/device port `7100`

adb kill-server

It terminates the *adb server* process. Sometimes you might want to terminate the *adb server* and restart it to resolve the problems.

Syntax:

```
adb kill-server
```

adb connect

The `adb connect` command allows using `adb` over Wi-Fi. It requires the host and the device connected to the same Wi-Fi network.

Syntax:

```
adb connect <host>[:<port>]
```

To use ADB over Wi-Fi, firstly connect the device to PC and set TCP IP port to 5555 using "`adb tcpip 5555`" command. Now find the IP address of the device from *Settings -> About -> Status -> IP address*. Now you can use `adb connect` command to use ADB over Wi-Fi.

Example:

```
adb connect 192.168.x.x:5555
```

adb usb

Restarts ADB in USB mode.

Syntax:

```
adb usb
```

adb install

The `adb install` command pushes an Android application (.apk) from host to an emulator or the device.

Syntax:

```
adb install [option] <path to .apk>
```

Example:

```
adb install test.apk
```



adb uninstall

Uninstalls or removes the package from the emulator or Android device.

Syntax:

```
adb uninstall [option] <PACKAGE>
```

Example:

```
adb uninstall com.test.app
```

adb shell pm list packages

The `adb shell pm list packages` command prints all packages installed on the device/emulator.

Syntax:

```
adb shell pm list packages [options] <FILTER>
```

Example:

```
adb shell pm list packages
```

adb shell pm path

The `adb shell pm path` command is used to prints the path to the APK of the given package.

Syntax:

```
adb shell pm path <PACKAGE>
```

Example:

```
adb shell pm path com.android.phone
```

adb shell pm clear

This command deletes all the data associated with the package (clears app data and cache).

Syntax:

```
adb shell pm clear <PACKAGE>
```

Example:

```
adb shell pm clear com.test.app
```

adb pull

Downloads or pulls a specified file from an emulator/device to your computer (host).

Syntax:



```
adb pull <remote> [local]
```

Example:

```
adb pull /sdcard/test.mp4
```

To download *test.mp4* to *drive D* below command is used.

```
adb pull /sdcard/test.mp4 d:¥
```

adb push

The `adb push` command is used to upload or push or copy a file from the host (computer) to an emulator or the device.

Syntax:

```
adb push <local> <remote>
```

Example:

```
adb push d:¥test.mp4 /sdcard
```

adb shell ls

Lists directory contents.

Syntax:

```
ls [options] <directory>
```

Example:

```
adb shell
```

```
ls
```

adb shell cd

Change the directory or folder.

Syntax:

```
cd <directory>
```

Example:

```
adb shell
```

```
cd /system
```

adb shell rm

The `adb shell rm` command is used to remove files or directories.

Syntax:



```
rm [options] <files or directory>
```

Example:

```
adb shell
```

```
rm /sdcard/test.pdf
```

adb shell mkdir

Make a directory or create a folder.

Syntax:

```
mkdir [options] <directory name>
```

Example:

```
adb shell
```

```
mkdir /sdcard/test
```

adb shell touch

Create an empty file or change file timestamps.

Syntax:

```
touch [options] <file>
```

Example:

```
adb shell
```

```
touch /sdcard/test.txt
```

adb shell pwd

Prints the current working directory location.

Syntax:

```
pwd
```

Example:

```
adb shell
```

```
pwd
```

adb shell cp

Copy files and directories.

Syntax:



```
cp [options] <source> <destination>
```

Example:

```
adb shell
```

```
cp /sdcard/text.txt /sdcard/folder/
```

adb shell mv

Move or rename files.

Syntax:

```
mv [options] <source> <destination>
```

Example:

```
adb shell
```

```
mv /sdcard/tmp /system/tmp
```

adb shell netstat

Shows network statistics.

Syntax:

```
netstat
```

Example:

```
adb shell
```

```
netstat
```

adb shell ping

Test the connection and the latency between two network connections.

Syntax:

```
ping [options] <destination>
```

Example:

```
adb shell
```

```
ping www.android.com
```

adb shell netcfg

Manage and configure network connections via profiles.

Syntax:



```
netcfg [<interface> {dhcp|up|down}]
```

Example:

```
adb shell
```

```
netcfg
```

adb shell ip

Show, manipulate routing, devices, policy routing, and tunnels.

Syntax:

```
ip [options] object
```

object := { link | addr | addrlabel | route | rule | neigh | ntable | tunnel | tuntap | maddr | mroute | mrule | monitor | xfrm | netns | l2tp }

options := { -V[ersion] | -s[tatistics] | -d[etails] | -r[esolve] | -f[amily] { inet | inet6 | ipx | dnet | link } | -l[oops] { maximum-addr-flush-attempts } | -o[neline] | -t[imestamp] | -b[atch] [filename] | -rc[vbuf] [size] }

Example:

```
adb shell
```

```
ip -f inet addr show wlan0
```

adb logcat

Prints log data on the screen.

Syntax:

```
adb logcat
```

adb shell dumpsys

Dumps system data.

Syntax:

```
adb shell dumpsys [options]
```

Example:

```
adb shell dumpsys
```

```
adb shell dumpsys batterystats
```

adb shell dumpstate

Dumps state.



Syntax:

```
adb shell dumpstate
```

adb shell screencap

The `adb shell screencap` command takes a screenshot of the device's display.

Syntax:

```
adb shell screencap <filename>
```

Example:

```
adb shell screencap /sdcard/screenshot.png
```

adb shell screenrecord

The `adb shell screenrecord` command records the device's screen. It requires the device to be running on Android 4.4 (API level 19) or higher.

Syntax:

```
adb shell screenrecord [options] <filename>
```

Example:

```
adb shell screenrecord /sdcard/screen.mp4
```

adb root

The `adb root` command is used to restarts the adbd daemon with root permissions.

Syntax:

```
adb root
```

adb sideload

Sideloads OTA update.zip package and other files on the device. Know more about [adb sideload](https://www.gizmoadvices.com/sideload-roms-and-zip-mods-using-adb-command-tool/) (<https://www.gizmoadvices.com/sideload-roms-and-zip-mods-using-adb-command-tool/>) here.

Syntax:

```
adb sideload <file.zip>
```

Example:

```
adb sideload update.zip
```

adb shell ps

Prints process status.



Syntax:

```
ps [options]
```

Example:

```
adb shell
```

```
ps
```

adb shell top

Displays top CPU processes.

Syntax:

```
top [options]
```

Example:

```
adb shell
```

```
top
```

adb shell getprop

Get property via the android property service.

Syntax:

```
getprop [options]
```

Example:

```
adb shell
```

```
getprop
```

adb shell setprop

This command is used to set property service.

Syntax:

```
setprop <key> <value>
```

Example:

```
adb shell
```

```
setprop service.adb.tcp.port 5555
```



What is Fastboot?

Fastboot is a diagnostic protocol primarily used to modify the flash filesystem via USB connection from the host computer. It requires the device to be booted into boot loader mode or fastboot mode or secondary program loader mode. Once the fastboot protocol is enabled, it accepts the commands sent to it via USB using the command-line interface.

List of Fastboot Commands and their Operations

Below is the list of fastboot commands which can be used to perform certain operations when the device is connected to the computer (host) in Fastboot mode / Bootloader mode.

| fastboot devices

This command is similar to [adb devices](#); it prints a list of all attached devices in fastboot mode. In response, it returns the serial number of the device.

Syntax:

```
fastboot devices
```

| fastboot reboot

The `fastboot reboot` command reboots the device to normal or standard mode. Used to exit the fastboot mode or boot loader mode.

Syntax:

```
fastboot reboot
```

| fastboot reboot recovery

The `fastboot reboot recovery` command boots the device into Recovery Mode.

Syntax:

```
fastboot reboot recovery
```

| fastboot oem unlock

The `fastboot oem unlock` command unlocks bootloader on the device.

Syntax:

```
fastboot oem unlock
```

| fastboot oem lock

Used to relock the bootloader on the device.

Syntax:



```
fastboot oem lock
```

fastboot oem device-info

Prints bootloader lock/unlock status.

Syntax:

```
fastboot oem device-info
```

fastboot flash recovery

The `fastboot flash recovery` command is used to flash the recovery image to the device.

Syntax:

```
fastboot flash recovery <file-name.img>
```

Example:

```
fastboot flash recovery twrp.img
```

fastboot boot

Used to boot the image file without installing or flashing on the device. Can be used to boot recovery image without flashing on the device.

Syntax:

```
fastboot boot <file-name.img>
```

Example:

```
fastboot boot recovery.img
```

fastboot flash

Flashes flashable zip file from fastboot or bootloader mode.

Syntax:

```
fastboot flash <file.zip>
```

Example:

```
fastboot flash update.zip
```

fastboot getvar cid

Displays CID (Carrier ID) of the device.

Syntax:

```
fastboot getvar cid
```



This was the complete list of ADB and Fastboot commands. However, to use the above fastboot and adb commands, make sure you have installed ADB and Fastboot drivers – [Windows \(https://www.gizmoadvices.com/setup-adb-and-fastboot-drivers-on-windows-pc-in-seconds/\)](https://www.gizmoadvices.com/setup-adb-and-fastboot-drivers-on-windows-pc-in-seconds/) and [Mac \(https://www.gizmoadvices.com/install-and-setup-adb-and-fastboot-drivers-on-mac/\)](https://www.gizmoadvices.com/install-and-setup-adb-and-fastboot-drivers-on-mac/).

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